Hashim proceeded to tell me he had made a decision to resign as captain at the end of the second Test, and wanted me to be prepared because he thought Cricket South Africa would ask me to take over. These were tough days for everyone, and once again I remember feeling so impressed by Hash's honesty and decency.

Nothing was said publicly but, perhaps privately feeling a burden had been lifted from his shoulders, Hash led our fightback at Newlands, scoring another outstanding double hundred. He was supported by me with 88, and then by Faf, who scored 86, as we set about rebuilding our credibility and self-confidence.

Hash was eventually out for 201, and his dismissal brought Temba Bavuma to the crease at 439 for four. Aged 25, raised in Langa near Cape Town and now playing for the Lions in Johannesburg, he batted beautifully, playing with freedom and enthusiasm, cutting and pulling his way to a maiden Test hundred. It was the first Test century scored by a black South African, ever. Even in the midst of what was in many ways a difficult and demanding series, South African cricket was visibly moving in the right direction.

The Test ended as a draw, and it was duly announced that Hash had decided to resign and that I would captain the side for the remaining two Tests of the series. I felt honoured, of course, and pleased to realise a boyhood ambition to become the Test captain, but these feelings were tempered by sympathy for Hashim's situation and the knowledge that we would have to play at the top of our game, consistently, if we were going to fight back and win the series. I believed we could compete with them and beat them, but we could not afford to be fragile.

For most of my career, the Proteas side would approach any Test match at home expecting to win. Those days were gone. Great players had retired, and we had entered a period of renewal.

The third Test at the Wanderers was always going to be a shootout. A result appeared certain, so we were either going to win and level the